

GitHub Portfolio

ICOM2703 – Professional Practice for IT 3

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Date: April 11th, 2026

Table of Contents

1. Portfolio Overview	3
2. Site Structure.....	3
3. Design with Tailwind CSS	4
4. Dynamic Project Loading.....	4
5. Version Control with Git.....	5
6. Old vs. New Portfolio.....	6
7. Conclusion	8
8. References	9

Table of Figures

Figure 1: Wireframe Design of the Second Iteration of the Portfolio.....	3
Figure 2: First Pull Request with the Branching Name and Conventional Commit.....	5
Figure 3: Old Portfolio - Markdown with Jekyll	6
Figure 4: New Portfolio – HTML, JavaScript, and Tailwind CSS	7

1. Portfolio Overview

The GitHub Portfolio was developed in two iterations: an initial version and a redesigned, modern version. The first iteration focused mainly on presenting the content using Markdown and Jekyll. On the other hand, the second iteration was rebuilt with HTML, JavaScript, and Tailwind CSS to improve structure, interactivity, and the overall look.

The goal of both portfolios is to give an overview of who I am, highlight my technical and soft skills, showcase completed projects, and demonstrate both academic and practical experience in a clean and professional format.

2. Site Structure

The new portfolio is designed as a single HTML page using a vertical layout. A horizontal navigation bar is positioned at the top of the page and remains fixed (sticky), allowing users to navigate between sections even when they are not at the top. Each section (About, Skills, Achievements, Projects, Documentation, Reflection, and Contact) is organized into cards. The sections are visually distinct to avoid repetition while maintaining consistency across the design.

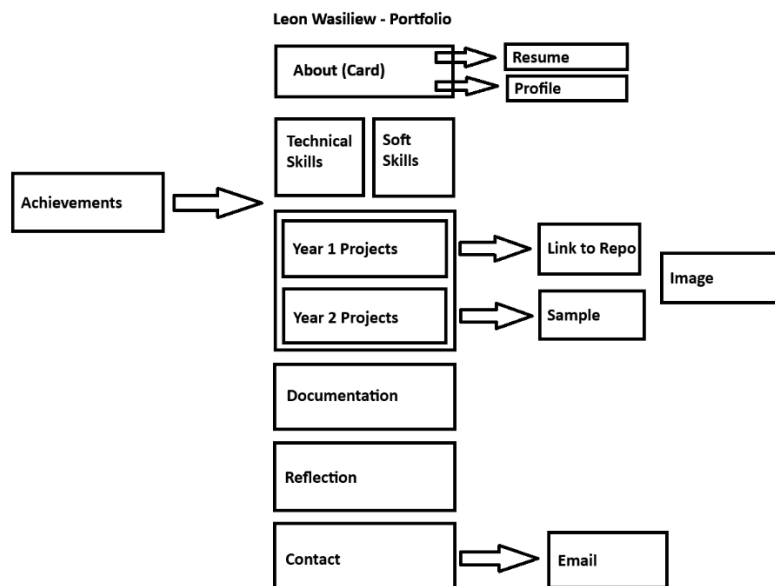


Figure 1: Wireframe Design of the Second Iteration of the Portfolio

3. Design with Tailwind CSS

Tailwind CSS was chosen over custom CSS or other frameworks such as Bootstrap due to its utility-first approach and flexibility. It allows for rapid development and consistent styling directly within HTML. This approach results in a clean design while maintaining control over layout, spacing, and responsiveness. Tailwind also simplifies maintaining a consistent color scheme across all sections of the portfolio.

The color palette of the new portfolio was selected to align with the visual identity of the NSCC logo, incorporating a blue tone (#004780) for headings and key UI elements. This choice reflects the academic environment associated with the program.

4. Dynamic Project Loading

The Projects section is dynamically generated using JavaScript. Project data is stored in a JSON file located at `assets/json/projects.json`. When the page loads, JavaScript fetches the data and renders project cards for both First Year and Second Year projects. This approach improves scalability since projects can be added by updating the JSON file without modifying the HTML.

Each card includes:

- Course name
- Project title
- Description
- Technology stack
- GitHub link
- Sample code link
- Project screenshot

The card layout is split into two sections:

- **Left:** project information and buttons
- **Right:** project screenshot

5. Version Control with Git

Git is used for version control, with GitHub as the hosting platform for both the portfolio and individual project repositories. A structured Git workflow is followed to ensure consistency and traceability of changes throughout development.

This project follows a branching strategy, where all work is completed in separate branches and merged into the main branch through pull requests. The main branch is reserved for stable code, while other branches are used for new features, fixes, etc.

A consistent branch naming convention is applied using the format “type/<description>.” For example, “docs/workflow-guidelines” was the first branch that was merged, as it adds documentation outlining the project’s branching strategy and commit message conventions.

Additionally, the project follows the Conventional Commits standard for commit messages. Each commit uses a specific format (type: description) with common types such as:

- feat for new features
- fix for bug fixes
- docs for documentation updates
- refactor for code restructuring

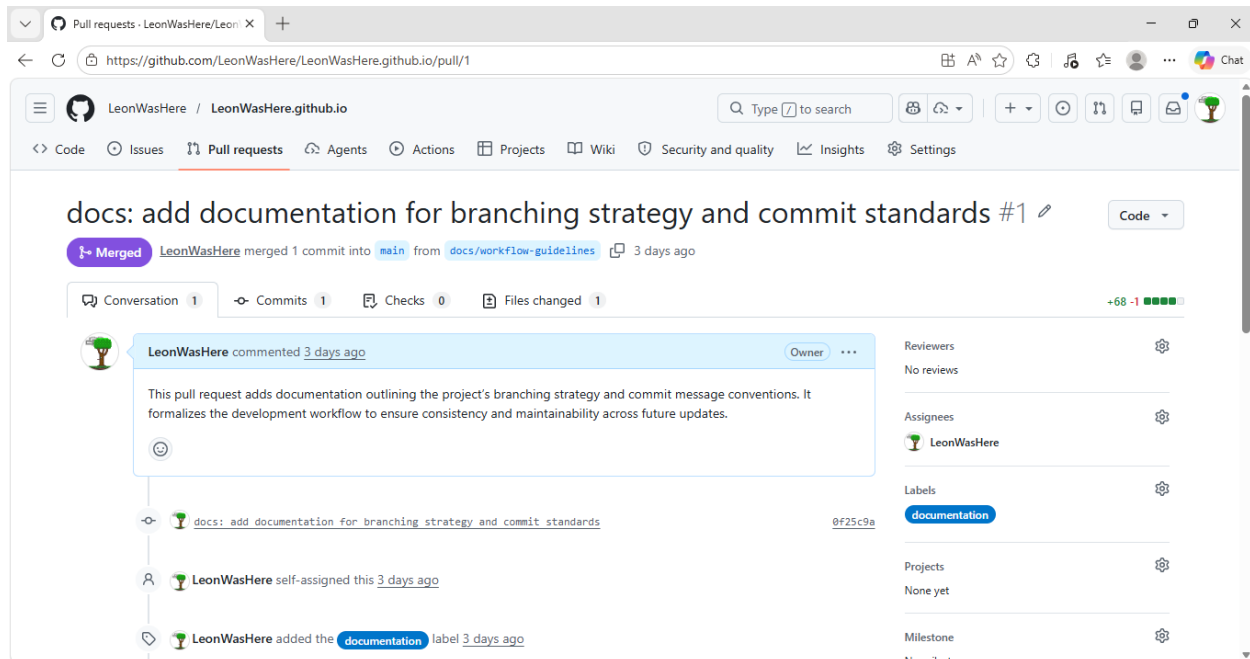


Figure 2: First Pull Request with the Branching Name and Conventional Commit

6. Old vs. New Portfolio

The old portfolio was built using Markdown and Jekyll, with content separated into multiple pages. Each section was accessed through navigation links near the top of the page that routed between different Markdown files.

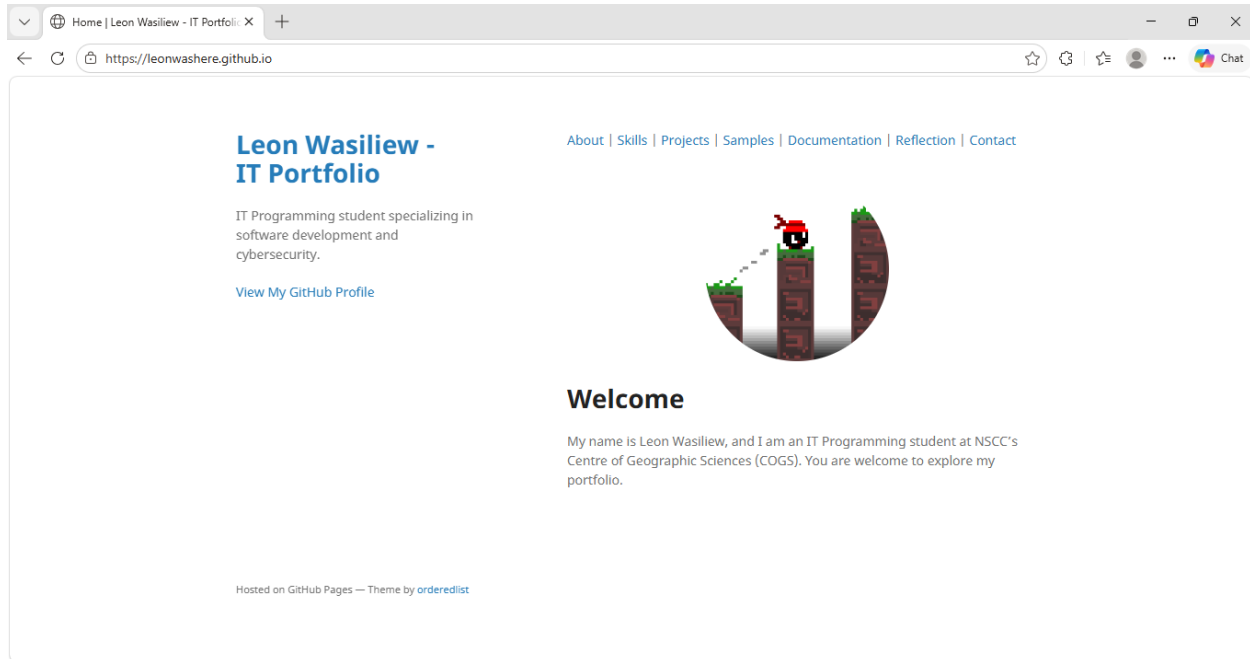


Figure 3: Old Portfolio - Markdown with Jekyll

In the updated version, the portfolio was redesigned as a single webpage using HTML, Tailwind CSS, and JavaScript. The previous version was archived in portfolio-prototype/.

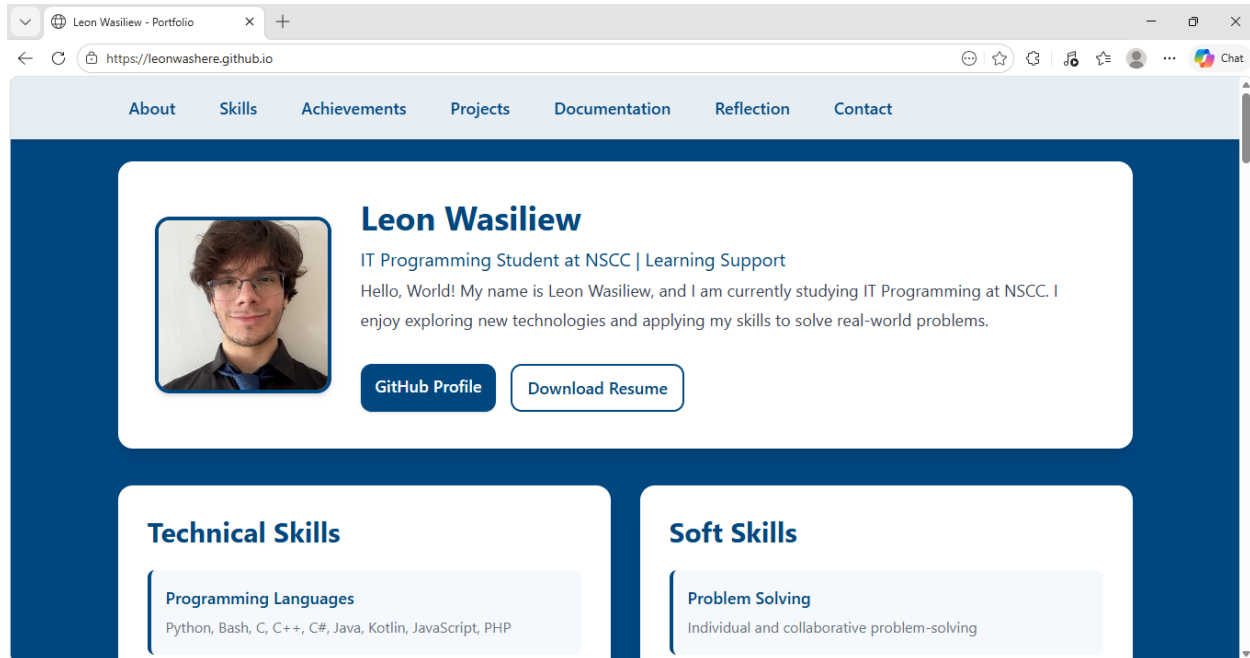


Figure 4: New Portfolio – HTML, JavaScript, and Tailwind CSS

Key improvements in the new version include:

- Unified single-page structure
- Modern UI using Tailwind CSS
- Dynamic project rendering using JavaScript
- Improved navigation and user experience

7. Conclusion

The new portfolio represents a clear improvement in both functionality and visuals. By moving to a more modern tech stack and introducing dynamic features, the site is now better aligned with current web development practices. It also provides a smoother and more consistent user experience compared to the earlier version.

Along with these technical changes, I also reworked the overall structure of the portfolio to make it more fleshed out. The original version included separate sections for About, Skills, Projects, Samples, Documentation, Reflection, and Contact. In the updated version, I introduced an Achievements section to better highlight the key experiences and removed the standalone Samples section. Instead of keeping samples separate, I integrated them directly into the Projects section, where each project now includes a button to view sample code.

In addition, I created dedicated GitHub repositories for each project (except the shared Capstone project) and linked them directly within the portfolio. This ensures that all projects are properly organized and accessible, allowing users to explore the code and documents.

Overall, this project reflects not only my technical skills, but also my ability to evaluate and improve my own work. The transition from the original portfolio to the current version demonstrates growth in areas such as design decisions and organization, resulting in a more polished final product.

8. References

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